

Birds

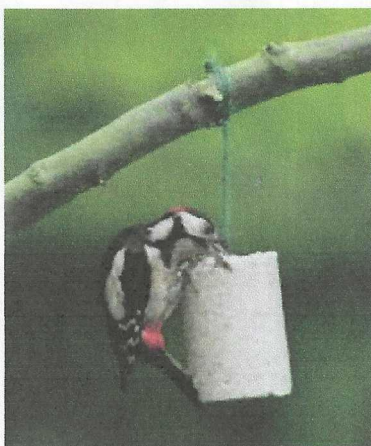
The BTO, British Trust For Ornithology, says



“Youngsters are ushered by their parents into gardens; a behaviour that is designed to help these fledglings towards independence, showing them where to find a reliable meal. It is a strategy that seems to work.”

So you might have been lucky enough to be running a bird nursery in your garden.

The drumming we hear in the early spring are the Great Spotted Woodpeckers marking out their territories. These are violent impacts that would result in concussion in people but woodpeckers have evolved ‘shock absorbers’ where the beak joins the skull. In fact their ability to handle such extreme impacts has made them the subject of research into way to reduce the risk of human head injuries!



They feed on insects and their larvae, eggs and young of birds, and on seed of trees. They also make short work of “a wide variety of foods in gardens, happily hammering peanuts, chiselling suet-blocks or clearing trays of mealworms”.